2020年09月四级真题第1套

原卷 / Question Paper · 年份 2020 | 月份 9 | 第一套 | 时长 125 分钟 | 满分 710（及格 425）

Part I 写作 (Writing)

Directions, For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to write an essay on online libraries. You can start your essay with the sentence "Online libraries are becoming increasingly popular". You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

建议时间：30 分钟 | 字数：120-180 | 分值：15

作答区

Part II 听力理解 (Listening Comprehension)

Section A news

短新闻

听力音频：audio/SectionA.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **What do we learn from the news report about the study?**
   - A. Ship traffic in the Atlantic.
   - B. Warm currents in the ocean.
   - C. Exhaust from cars in Europe.
   - D. Particles emitted by power plants.
2. **What do NASA officials think about the thick clouds?**
   - A. They need to be taken seriously.
   - B. They have a huge effect on fishery.
   - C. They might be causing trouble to air flights.
   - D. They may be affecting the world’s climate.
3. **For what purpose did the staff at a supermarket in Melbourne sign a letter?**
   - A. To appeal for higher wages.
   - B. To demand better health care.
   - C. To call for a permanent security guard.
   - D. To dismiss the bad-tempered supervisor.
4. **What did the spokesman of the supermarket say regarding the employees demand?**
   - A. It had already taken strong action.
   - B. It would put customers’ needs first.
   - C. It would take their appeal seriously.
   - D. It was seeking help from the police.
5. **What did drivers on the motorway to water or find?**
   - A. The road was flooded.
   - B. The road was blocked.
   - C. The road was frozen with snow.
   - D. The road was covered with spilled gas.
6. **What does the report say about the accident?**
   - A. A truck plunged into a pool of liquid chocolate.
   - B. The heavy snow made driving very difficult.
   - C. The truck driver dozed off while driving.
   - D. A truck hit a barrier and overturned.
7. **What did the firefighters representative tell the local TV?**
   - A. It was a long time before the cleanup was finished.
   - B. It was a hard task to remove the spilled substance.
   - C. It was fortunate that no passenger got injured.
   - D. It was difficult to contact the manufacturer.

Section B conversations

长对话

听力音频：audio/SectionB.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **Why did the woman decide to go back to cash for payment?**
   - A. She wanted to save for a new phone.
   - B. She found it much safer to use cash.
   - C. She could enjoy discounts with cash.
   - D. She had been cheated using phone apps.
2. **What happens when people use apps for payment?**
   - A. They can save a lot more time and trouble.
   - B. They find it less difficult to make purchases.
   - C. They derive greater pleasure from buying things.
   - D. They are less aware of the value of their money.
3. **According to the woman, what might the man tend to buy with payment apps?**
   - A. More valuable items.
   - B. More non-essential items.
   - C. Everyday necessities.
   - D. Electronic devices.
4. **What is the man think of electronic payment?**
   - A. It can improve shopping efficiency.
   - B. It is altering the way of shopping.
   - C. It may lead to excessive spending.
   - D. It appeals more to younger people.
5. **Why did the man call the woman?**
   - A. He wanted to order some wooden furniture.
   - B. He had to change the furniture delivery time.
   - C. He had a problem with the furniture delivered.
   - D. He wanted the furniture store to give him a refund.
6. **What did the woman asked the man to do?**
   - A. Send the furniture back to the store.
   - B. Describe the furniture he received.
   - C. Collect the furniture he ordered.
   - D. Buy another brand of furniture.
7. **What did the woman promise to do for the man?**
   - A. Correct their mistake.
   - B. Improve their service.
   - C. Apologize to his wife.
   - D. Give the money back.
8. **What did the woman do at the end of the conversation?**
   - A. She recommended a new style.
   - B. She offered some gift to the man.
   - C. She apologized to the man once more.
   - D. She checked all the items with the man.

Section C passages

听力篇章

听力音频：audio/SectionC.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **What is Marie condos TV show about?**
   - A. Reading books of wisdom.
   - B. Tidying up one’s home.
   - C. Sharing with others.
   - D. Donating to charity.
2. **What things can be kept in one's home, according to Marie Condo?**
   - A. Things that make one happy.
   - B. Things that are becoming rare.
   - C. Things that occupy little space.
   - D. Things that cost a lot of money.
3. **What do we learn about one used bookstore this January?**
   - A. It joined the city’s clean-up campaign.
   - B. It sold as many as fifty boxes of books.
   - C. It received an incredibly large number of donated books.
   - D. It did little business because of the unusual cold weather.
4. **What does Mike Hanon do to help people in his town?**
   - A. Give free meals to the homeless.
   - B. Provide shelter for the homeless.
   - C. Help the vulnerable to cook lunches.
   - D. Call for change in the local government.
5. **What does Mike hope others will do?**
   - A. Strengthen co-operation.
   - B. Promote understanding.
   - C. Win national support.
   - D. Follow his example.
6. **How are people all over the country responding to what Mike is doing?**
   - A. Spreading news of his deeds.
   - B. Writing him thank-you notes.
   - C. Following the example he sets.
   - D. Sending him hand-made bags.
7. **What were the college students in both groups required to do in the study?**
   - A. To solve word search puzzles.
   - B. To send smartphone messages.
   - C. To test their eyesight using a phone app.
   - D. To install some audio equipment in a lab.
8. **What do we learn about many of the students in the second test group after the phone rang?**
   - A. They could not go on until the ringing stopped.
   - B. They could no longer concentrate on their task.
   - C. They grabbed the phone and called back right away.
   - D. They asked their experimenter to hang up the phone.
9. **According to the passage, what is the most dramatic impact of smartphone use?**
   - A. A rise in emotional problems.
   - B. A decline in sports activities.
   - C. A reduction in the amount of sleep.
   - D. A decline in academic performance.
10. **What does the speaker suggest people do?**
   - A. Protect the eyesight of the younger generation.
   - B. Take effective measures to raise productivity.
   - C. Realize the disruptive effects of technology.
   - D. Ensure they have sufficient sleep every day.

Part III 阅读理解 (Reading Comprehension)

Section A 选词填空

Word Bank（词库）

A) appearance
B) argued
C) avoid
D) considerable
E) definitely
F) extreme
G) inaction
H) incredibly
I) normal
J) possibly
K) proposition
L) rebelled
M) statement
N) tend
O) traditional

There’re three main types of financial stress people encounter. The first type is apparent in people being stressed about the **__26__** ups and downs of investment markets—actually not so much the ups, but **__27__** the downs. These people are usually unable or unprepared to endure the long haul.

The next common type of financial stress is that caused by debt. In a **__28__** percentage of cases of debt-induced financial stress, credit cards and loans will be a central element. Often there’ll be a car loan and perhaps a mortgage, but credit cards often seem to be the gateway to debt-related financial difficulties for many.

The third type of stress and **__29__** the least known is inherited financial stress, which is the most destructive. It is experienced by those who have grown up in households where their parents regularly **__30__** and fought about money. Money therefore becomes a stressful topic, and so the thought of sitting down and planning is an unattractive **__31__**.

Those suffering inherited financial anxiety **__32__** to follow one of two patterns. Either they put their head in the sand: they would **__33__** examining their financial statements, budgeting, and discussing financial matters with those closest to them. Alternatively, they would go to the other **__34__**, and micro-analyze everything, to the point of complete **__35__**. They’re convinced that whatever decision they make will be the wrong one.

空格题号：26、27、28、29、30、31、32、33、34、35

Section B 段落匹配

Directions: 阅读下列段落，为每个句子选出所对应的段落。每个段落可能被选一次、多次或不被选择。

A Imagine a drug that could enhance a child’s creativity and critical thinking. Imagine that this drug were simple to make, safe to take, and could be had for free. The nation’s leading pediatricians（儿科医生） say this miracle compound exists. In a new clinical report, they are urging doctors to prescribe it liberally to the children in their care.

B “This may seem old-fashioned, but there are skills to be learned when kids aren’t told what to do,” said Dr. Michael Yogman, a Harvard Medical School pediatrician who led the drafting of the call to arms. Whether it’s rough physical play, outdoor play or pretend play, kids derive important lessons from the chance to make things up as they go, he said.

C The advice, issued Monday by the American Academy of Pediatrics, may come as a shock to some parents. After spending years fretting （烦恼） over which toys to buy, which apps to download and which skill-building programs to send their kids to after school, letting them simply play—or better yet, playing with them—could seem like a step backward. The pediatricians insist that it’s not. The academy’s guidance does not include specific recommendations for the dosing of play. Instead, it asks doctors to advise parents before their babies turn two that play is essential to healthy development.

D “Play is not silly behavior,” the academy’s report declares. It fosters children’s creativity, cooperation and problem-solving skills—all of which are critical for a 21st-century workforce.
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When parents engage in play with their children, it builds a wall against the harmful effects of all kinds of stress, including poverty, the academy says. In the pediatricians’ view, essentially every life skill that’s valued in adults can be built up with play. “Collaboration, negotiation, decision-making, creativity, leadership, and increased physical activity are just some of the skills and benefits children gain through play,” they wrote. The pediatricians’ appeal comes as kids are being squeezed by increasing academic demands at school and the constant invasion of digital media.

E The trends have been a long time coming. Between 1981 and 1997, detailed time-use studies showed that the time children spent at play declined by 25 percent. Since the adoption of sweeping education reforms in 2001, public schools have steadily increased the amount of time devoted to preparing for standardized tests. The focus on academic “skills and drills” has cut deeply into recess （课间休息） and other time for free play.

F By 2009, a study of Los Angeles kindergarten classrooms found that five-year-olds were so burdened with academic requirements that they were down to an average of just 19 minutes per day of “choice time,” when they were permitted to play freely with blocks, toys or other children. One in four Los Angeles teachers reported there was no time at all for “free play.” Increased academic pressures have left 30 percent of U.S. kindergarten classes without any recess. Such findings prompted the American Academy of Pediatrics to issue a policy statement in 2013 on the “crucial role of recess in school.”

G Pediatricians aren’t the only ones who have noticed. In a report titled “Crisis in the Kindergarten,” a group of educators, health professionals and child advocates called the loss of play in early childhood “a tragedy, both for the children themselves and for our nation and the world.” Kids in play-based kindergartens “end up equally good or better at reading and other intellectual skills, and they are more likely to become well-adjusted healthy people,” the Alliance for Childhood said in 2009. Indeed, new research demonstrates why playing with blocks might have been time better spent, Yogman said. The trial assessed the effectiveness of an early mathematics intervention（干预） aimed at preschoolers. The results showed almost no gains in math achievement.

H Another playtime thief: the growing proportion of kids’ time spent in front of screens and digital devices, even among preschoolers. Last year, Common Sense Media reported that children up through age eight spent an average of two hours and 19 minutes in front of screens each day, including an average of 42 minutes a day for those under two. This increase of digital use comes with rising risks of obesity, sleep deprivation and cognitive （认知的）, language and social-emotional delays, the American Academy of Pediatrics warned in 2016.
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I “I respect that parents have busy lives and it’s easy to hand a child an iPhone,” Yogman said. “But there’s a cost to that. For young children, it’s much too passive. And kids really learn better when they’re actively engaged and have to really discover things.”

J The decline of play is a special hazard for the roughly 1 in 5 children in the United States who live in poverty. These 14 million children most urgently need to develop the resilience （韧劲） that is cultivated with play. Instead, Yogman said, they are disproportionately affected by some of the trends that are making play scarce: academic pressures at schools that need to improve test scores, outside play areas that are limited or unsafe, and parents who lack the time or energy to share in playtime.

K Yogman also worries about the pressures that squeeze playtime for more affluent kids. “The notion that as parents we need to schedule every minute of their time is not doing them a great service,” he said. Even well-meaning parents may be “robbing them of the opportunity to have that joy of discovery and curiosity—the opportunity to find things out on their own.”

L Play may not be a hard sell to kids. But UCLA pediatrician Carlos Lerner acknowledged that the pediatricians’ new prescription may meet with skepticism （怀疑） from parents, who are anxious for advice on how to give their kids a leg up in the world. They should welcome the simplicity of the message, Lerner said. “It’s liberating to be able to offer them this advice: that you spending time with your child and letting him play is one of the most valuable things you can do,” he said. “It doesn’t have to involve spending a lot of money or time, or joining a parenting group. It’s something we can offer that’s achievable. They just don’t recognize it right now as particularly valuable.”

待匹配句子

36. Increased use of digital devices steals away children’s playtime.

37. Since the beginning of this century, an increasing amount of time has been shifted in public schools from recess to academic activities.

38. It has been acknowledged that while kids may welcome pediatricians’ recommendation, their parents may doubt its feasibility.

39. According to some professionals, deprivation of young children’s playtime will do harm not only to children themselves but to the country and the world.

40. By playing with children, parents can prevent them from being harmed by stress.

41. Playing with digital devices discourages kids from active discovery, according to pediatrician Dr. Michael Yogman.

42. The suggestion of letting children simply play may sound like going backwards to parents who want to help build their children’s skills.

43. Dr. Michael Yogman believes the idea that parents should carefully schedule children’s time may not be helpful to their growth.

44. One quarter of teachers in an American city said that children in kindergartens had no time for playing freely.

45. According to a pediatrician, no matter what kind of play children engage in, they are learning how to create things.

Section C 阅读理解

Passage One

Americans spend billions of dollars each year trying to change our weight with diets, gym memberships and plastic surgery.

Trying to live up to the images of “perfect” models and movie heroes has a dark side: anxiety, depression, as well as unhealthy strategies for weight loss or muscle gain. It also has a financial cost. Having an eating disorder boosts annual health care costs by nearly US $ 2,000 per person.

Why is there both external and internal pressure to look “perfect”? One reason is that society rewards people who are thin and healthy-looking. Researchers have shown that body mass index is related to wages and income. Especially for women, there is a clear penalty at work for being overweight or obese. Some studies have also found an impact for men, though a less noticeable one.

While the research literature is clear that labor market success is partly based on how employers and customers perceive your body image, no one had explored the other side of the question. Does a person’s own perception of body image matter to earnings and other indicators of success in the workplace?

Our recently published study answered this question by tracking a large national random sample of Americans over a critical time period when bodies change from teenage shape into adult form and
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when people build their identities.

As in other research, women in our sample tend to over-perceive weight—they think they’re heavier than they are—while men tend to under-perceive theirs.

We found no relationship between the average person’s self-perception of weight and labor market outcomes, although self-perceived weight can influence self-esteem （自尊心）, mental health and health behaviors.

While the continued gender penalty in the labor market is frustrating, our finding that misperceived weight does not harm workers is more heartening.

Since employers’ perception of weight is what matters in the labor market, changing discrimination laws to include body type as a category would help. Michigan is the only state that prohibits discrimination on the basis of weight and height. We believe expanding such protections would make the labor market more fair and efficient.

1. **What does the author say may have an adverse impact on people?**
   - A. Undergoing plastic surgeries in pursuit of beauty.
   - B. Imitating the lifestyles of heroes and role models.
   - C. Striving to achieve perfection regardless of financial cost.
   - D. Attempting to meet society’s expectation of appearance.
2. **What have researchers found out about people’s earnings?**
   - A. They are closely related to people’s social status.
   - B. They have to do with people’s body weight and shape.
   - C. They seem to matter much less to men than to women.
   - D. They may not be equal to people’s contributions.
3. **What does the author’s recent study focus on?**
   - A. Previous literature on indicators of competitiveness in the workplace.
   - B. Traits that matter most in one’s pursuit of success in the labor market.
   - C. Whether self-perception of body image impacts one’s workplace success.
   - D. How bosses’ perception of body image impacts employees’ advancement.
4. **What is the finding of the author’s recent research?**
   - A. Being overweight actually does not do much harm to the overall well-being of employees.
   - B. People are not adversely affected in the workplace by false self-perception of body weight.
   - C. Self-esteem helps to combat gender inequality in the workplace.
   - D. Gender inequality continues to frustrate a lot of female employees.
5. **What does the author think would help improve the situation in the labor market?**
   - A. Banning discrimination on the basis of employees’ body image.
   - B. Expanding protection of women against gender discrimination.
   - C. Helping employees change their own perception of beauty.
   - D. Excluding body shape as a category in the labor contract.

Passage Two

Work-life balance is dead. By this, I’m not advocating that you should give up your quest to have a fulfilling career and a thriving personal life, and I am definitely not saying that you have to give up one to have the other. I also acknowledge that we have a work-life problem, but I’m arguing that the concept of balance has never been helpful, because it’s too limiting. You see, our language makes a difference, and how we refer to things matters because it affects our thinking and therefore our actions.

At the minimum, most of us work because we want to be able to support ourselves, our families, and the people around us. In the ideal world, we’re all doing work that we’re proud of and that provides meaning and purpose to us. But even if your job doesn’t give you shivers of joy with each new day, working is a part of what each of us does and the contribution we make to society. When you separate work and life, it’s a little bit harder to make that connection. But when you think of work as part of a full life and a complete experience, it becomes easier to see that success in one aspect often supports another.

Losing your balance and falling isn’t pleasant. A goal to balance suggests that things could quickly get off balance, and that causes terrible outcomes. It’s more constructive to think of solutions that continue to evolve over shifts in life and work. Rather than falling or failing, you may have good days or better days or not-so-good days. These variations are normal, and it’s more useful to think of life as something that is ever evolving and changing, rather than a high-risk enterprise where things could go wrong with one misstep.

How we talk to ourselves matters, and how we talk about issues makes a difference. Let’s bury “work-life balance” and think bigger and better about work-life fulfillment to do a little less balancing and a lot more living.
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1. **What does the author suggest by saying “The work-life balance is dead”?**
   - A. The hope of achieving a thriving life is impossible to realize.
   - B. The pursuit of a fulfilling career involves personal sacrifice.
   - C. The imbalance between work and life simply doesn’t exist anymore.
   - D. The concept of work-life balance contributes little to a fulfilling life.
2. **What does the author say about our use of language?**
   - A. It impacts how we think and behave.
   - B. It changes with the passage of time.
   - C. It reflects how we communicate.
   - D. It differs from person to person.
3. **What does the author say we do in an ideal world?**
   - A. We do work that betters the lives of our families and friends.
   - B. We do work that gives us bursts of joy each new day.
   - C. We do meaningful work that contributes to society.
   - D. We do demanding work that brings our capacity into full play.
4. **What does the author say about life?**
   - A. It is cyclical.
   - B. It is dynamic.
   - C. It is fulfilling.
   - D. It is risky.
5. **What does the author advise us to do?**
   - A. Make life as simple as possible.
   - B. Talk about balance in simpler terms.
   - C. Balance life and work in a new way.
   - D. Strive for a more fulfilling life.

Part IV 翻译 (Translation)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on Answer Sheet 2.

茅台（Moutai）是中国最有名的白酒，在新中国成立前夕，被选为国宴用酒。
据说赤水沿岸的村民四千年前就开始酿造茅台。在西汉时期，那里的人们生产出了高质量
的茅台，并把它贡给皇帝。自唐朝开始，这种地方酒通过海上丝绸之路运往海外。
茅台味道柔和，有一种特殊的香味；适量饮用可以帮助缓解疲劳，有镇静作用，因而广受国
内外消费者的喜爱。

建议时间：30 分钟 | 分值：15

作答区